

Fifteen Tracks, One Accounting Spine

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Abstract

Taxlane divides federal fiscal analysis into fifteen tracks while preserving a shared accounting spine. This paper explains why heterogeneous public purposes need different outcome tests and why their fiscal effects still require common rules for signs, funds, timing, overlap, and typed output. It focuses on the interfaces that keep Social Security, payment integrity, revenue, and net interest from becoming additive spending reductions. The architecture produces two surviving typed outputs and zero admitted FY2026 primary spending savings.

Evidence keys route to the EXPL-A ledgers. The shared fiscal object remains a one-year model rail, not total receipts/outlays, trust-fund solvency, borrowing, or formal balance [CLM-11, CLM-12].

1. Why tracks exist

Federal activity includes public goods, transfers, insurance-like commitments, administration, enforcement, infrastructure, and debt service. Their goals and beneficiaries differ. Transportation safety cannot be assessed with a poverty measure; health access cannot be reduced to force readiness; a justice grant cannot be evaluated only by federal cash timing.

Tracks preserve those distinctions. They are not a claim that federal money is literally divided into fifteen jars or that every track should have a dedicated tax.

2. Why one spine exists

Differences in purpose do not excuse inconsistent arithmetic. Every track must identify the fiscal object, year basis, sign, fund relationship, source, candidate, implementation state, interaction, and output type. Shared CORE interfaces enforce fund-flow reconciliation, temporal boundaries, cross-track allocation, candidate dossiers, and typed release surfaces.

This architecture answers a recurring question: what can be combined? Only effects with compatible scope, timing, ownership, and accounting treatment may enter the same fiscal identity.

3. The terminal map

The fifteen tracks [NUM-01] end in six disposition classes:

- conditional typed output (TRN);

- reviewed zero admission (HLT, EDU, ISF, VET, AGR, DEF, DIS, JUS, SEE, INT);
- dedicated solvency overlay (OAS);
- non-additive measurement overlay (PAY);
- internal analytical recommendation (REV);
- endogenous result (NET).

The classification matters more than a single ranked list. A conditional cost note can report cost without becoming a saving. A dedicated financing option can be analytically serious without reducing the ordinary-income target. An endogenous result can equal zero because no upstream change was admitted.

4. OAS: dedicated financing is not primary savings

Social Security's payroll-tax and trust-fund relationships carry legal, calendar/fiscal, cohort, adequacy, employer, and long-range questions. Taxlane keeps a taxable-maximum option on a dedicated-solvency rail. Treating additional dedicated receipts as a primary spending reduction or ordinary-income package credit would mix fiscal objects and conceal incidence.

5. PAY: measurement is not additive cash

Payment integrity operates across program owners. A central measurement can overlap effects later recorded in health, agriculture, income security, or other lanes. PAY therefore remains non-additive until realized effects are attributed to owners and netted for returns, appeals, implementation, burden, and distribution. The architecture prevents a gross control number from being summed twice.

6. NET: feedback is not a direct cut

Net interest responds to primary deficits, cash timing, debt maturity, and rates. Taxlane prohibits a direct interest cut. NET consumes admitted upstream annual paths and returns an endogenous result. With zero admitted primary spending reduction in the final pass, its upstream-driven contribution remains zero. A nonzero debt path would reopen it.

7. REV: the residual financing interface

REV receives the remaining target after admissible primary effects and the PAY/OAS/NET boundaries are honored. The \$813.727 billion target [NUM-04] is specific to the frozen FY2026 ordinary-income model rail. It is not total receipts, total outlays, trust-fund solvency, or formal balance.

The rate card is a typed internal analytical output. It can report a preferred schedule and uncertainty tiers while remaining explicitly nonofficial and nonstatutory.

8. Public-purpose and fungibility tradeoff

Legible tracks help citizens see why money is collected and what claims are being made. But transparency does not repeal fungibility or the appropriations process. A clearer receipt can label propor-

tional or illustrative allocations without creating dedicated taxes. A proposed dedicated lane would require separate rules for authority, shortfalls, reserves, service continuity, and override.

Taxlane therefore treats the track architecture first as an analytical and explanatory system. It does not assume that visibility alone controls spending or that every purpose should be financed the same way.

9. Result and limits

Two typed outputs survive: TRN's conditional cost note and REV's internal planning rate card. Ten tracks close at reviewed zero admission [NUM-02]; OAS, PAY, and NET retain special accounting roles. Admitted FY2026 primary spending reduction is zero [NUM-03].

The architecture does not confer legal authority, settle distributional value choices, or supply missing compliance and transition designs. Its contribution is a checked interface between heterogeneous evidence and common fiscal arithmetic.

A reopened program candidate still requires a shortfall and service-continuity rule where beneficiaries or legal commitments create reliance. The architecture is analytically recomputable; it creates no automatic rate, base, or appropriation authority [CLM-13].

Evidence

1. data/derived/breadth_benchmark_matrix/fifteen_track_terminal_disposition.v1.draft.json
2. data/derived/breadth_benchmark_matrix/core_h_shared_accounting_substrate.v1.draft.json
3. data/derived/breadth_benchmark_matrix/core_m_candidate_dossier_typed_release_contract.v1.draft.json
4. data/derived/breadth_benchmark_matrix/core_n_typed_public_release_surface_contract.v1.draft.json
5. data/derived/breadth_benchmark_matrix/fifteen_track_integrated_dependency_admission_rerun.v1.draft.json